

LCD MONITORS

LCD monitors have become synonymous with most desktop PCs; their flexibility in terms of placement, compactness and the fact that their prices have been steadily diminishing assured them steady market demand. To be honest the last six months has actually seen stagnation in terms of demand; the period of sharp growth was only till mid-2008. Prices that were tumbling have suddenly stabilised; it seems manufacturers have realised that demand will sustain itself; and price need not be any lower to ensure steady consumption.

The way the market stands today, the 22-inch category is the sweet spot between price and screen size at the moment. 19-inch and 17-inch LCDs still sell a lot more; but these are the new value category. 15-inch monitors have largely become obsolete except for non-Internet and multimedia tasks. The 24-inch category offers the most performance in terms of screen size; as these monitors typically support a full HD resolution of 1920 x 1200 pixels; which means they are more for those into gaming at maximum resolutions and movie buffs than regular multimedia users.

22-inch Monitors

REIGNING CHAMPION

Dell SP 2208 WFP

This monitor is based on a glossy, TN panel and besides this we could hardly find any fault. Its got a good contrast ratio and brightness levels will not disappoint unless you are really discerning. We found it good for movies and games except when the glossy panel causes reflections. The presence of an integrated 2.0 megapixel webcam is just sweet; especially for a price of Rs 15,000. It's got an HDMI port too; so it can be used with a home entertainment system as well.



BEST PERFORMER

LG 246WP

With a static contrast ratio of 1000:1, the 246WP is based on an eight-bit MVA panel and offers a matte finished panel that doesn't cause distractions due to reflections. This monitor has a superb brightness level and the contrast ratio is good enough for it to top the DisplayMate suite of tests. Its great for movies with a resolution of 1920 x 1200 pixels. In fact any user will appreciate the huge desktop size available; once you work with 24-inches of desktop you will never want to downgrade. Movies and games are fun; and this includes dark atmospheric games like S.T.A.L.K.E.R. and F.E.A.R.; you will see the darkest of scenes in proper detail; something that a TN panel-based LCD can never give you.

It's the best monitor for any sort of multimedia usage; and the best part is its price — Rs 24,000; which we feel is a steal for a monitor that provides amazing performance and a plethora of connectivity options that includes HDMI and Component connects.

CHALLENGERS

Samsung T220

The Samsung T220 represents the best of the design elements from their Bordeaux series of



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large screen LCD displays. This is a beautiful monitor that is a decent performer. It scores in the looks department mainly although gamers will not find anything serious to complain about. However its contrast ratio is not as good as the Dell SP 2208 WFP.

AND THE WINNER IS

Dell SP 2208 WFP



Dells 22-inch LCD is a winner in more ways than one. Good connectivity options, excellent performance for a TN panel, a great price all coupled with a good webcam makes it a killer deal.

17-inch Monitors

REIGNING CHAMPION

Dell 1708 FP

This monitor is superbly built monitor with a height, swivel and angle adjust stand; this in



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itself is a feature that is unheard of in the 17-inch category which is usually considered one for users on a shoestring budget. It's a TN panel so it didn't ace our DisplayMate tests; but very few 17-inch monitors based on TN panels usually do. The best part is, it's experienced a price drop; from Rs 11,500 to Rs 9,500. Which makes it a decent deal for someone looking for a monitor that will tilt and even swivel.

CHALLENGER(S)

None

AND THE WINNER IS

Dell 1708 FP



Dell scores in the 17-inch segment as well. This monitor is very well built; it performs rather decently and has a juicy price tag that may be hard to ignore when you look at the attention to detail in the stand among other parts.